

File Case #1

Case ID: 78B **Case Title:** The "Silent Canvas" Case **Date:** October 12, 2008 **Status:** Unsolved (Cold Case)

Crime Summary: A robbery was perpetrated at the city's Modern Art Gallery. The stolen artwork was "**Starry Night over the River**," by the acclaimed contemporary painter **Javier Soto**, valued at 3 million euros. The theft occurred overnight, without any of the pressure, motion, or laser alarms sounding.

Modus Operandi (M.O.): The thief demonstrated extremely advanced technical knowledge. The alarms were neutralized using a device that emitted a specific sonic frequency, temporarily uncalibrating the sensors without leaving a trace in the system. The armored glass of the display case was cut with a high-precision diamond tool, leaving a **perfect circle**. The perpetrator did not use brute force at any time.

Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect:** An unidentified individual known by the alias "**El Maestro**" (**The Master**). Believed to be a gentleman thief with experience in high-end security systems. No fingerprints or DNA were obtained.
- **Key Witnesses:** None. The on-duty security guard reported no anomalies.
- **Victim:** The Modern Art Gallery and the private collector who owned the artwork.

Key Evidence:

- Microscopic fragments of a **quartz crystal** near the display case, possibly from a custom sonic emitter.
- The circular cut in the armored glass, suggesting the use of a specialized, non-commercial tool.
- Security logs corrupted in a **30-minute loop**, precisely during the estimated time of the robbery.

Forensic Analysis: Analysis of the quartz crystal did not yield any matches in commercial databases. The lab concluded that the emitter device was likely **homemade** and of a **unique design**. Analysis of the security system revealed that the log corruption was done **remotely**, exploiting a **zero-day vulnerability** in the system's firmware, which was previously unknown.

Resolution: The case remains unsolved. The artwork was never recovered, and the identity of "El Maestro" remains a mystery. The case is a **paradigmatic example of high-tech heists**.